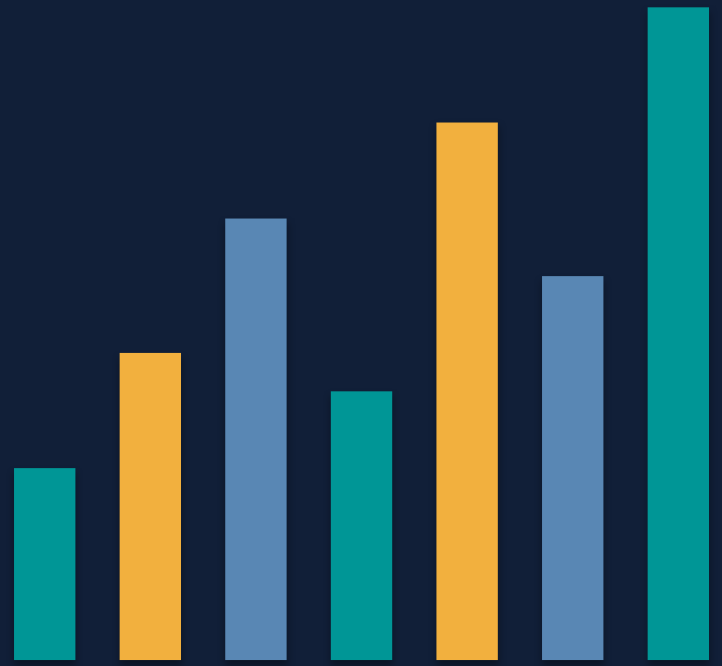
GLOBAL FUEL PRICING

A data story of prices, taxes, income levels and subsidies

Dataset period: 6 Jan 2020 – 6 Apr 2026 | 84 countries | 27,468 records



STORY-DRIVEN ANALYSIS

1. The question behind the numbers

INTRODUCTION

Research question

• Why do fuel prices differ so widely across countries and regions?

• How did average fuel prices move from 2020 through the available part of 2026?

• How are taxes, income levels and subsidy categories associated with prices?

Data & approach

• 27,468 weekly records across 84 countries and 7 regions.

• Fuel measures: petrol, diesel and LPG in USD per litre; Brent crude in USD; tax percentage and subsidy category.

• Compare group averages and annual averages; use correlation as association, not proof of cause.

Source: supplied global_fuel_prices_Dataset(2).csv

2. What the dataset covers

SCOPE & INTERPRETATION

27,468
records

84
countries

7
regions

2020–2026
2026 data ends 6 April

Important reading note

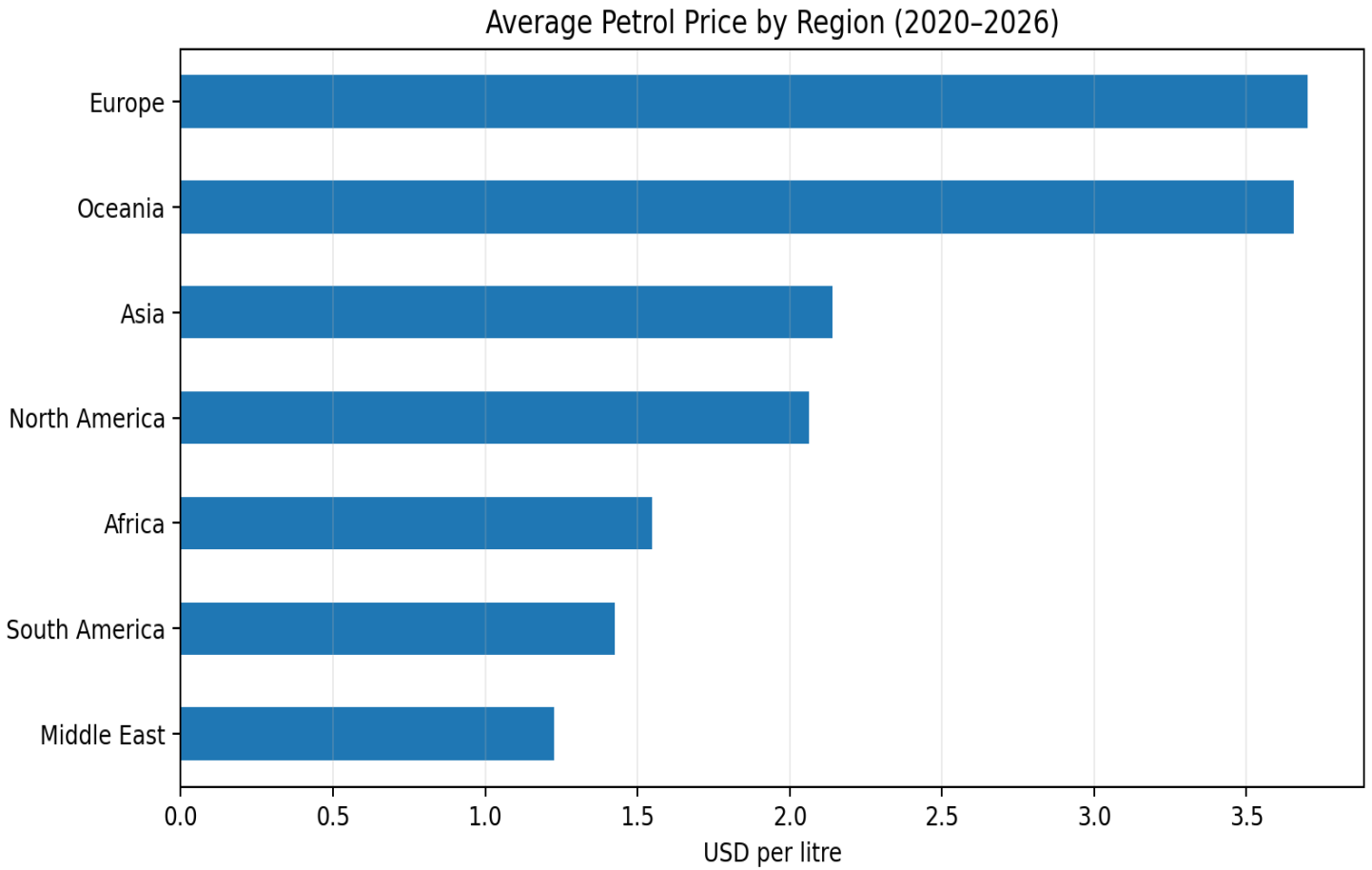
The final year is partial, so its average is not a full-year result. The file contains no missing values in the checked columns. Tax and subsidy fields are treated as recorded categories/measurements; the dataset alone cannot prove policy causes.

All findings below are descriptive averages from this file, not live market quotations.

Source: supplied global_fuel_prices_Dataset(2).csv

3. Geography changes the price at the pump

GEOGRAPHIC DISPARITY



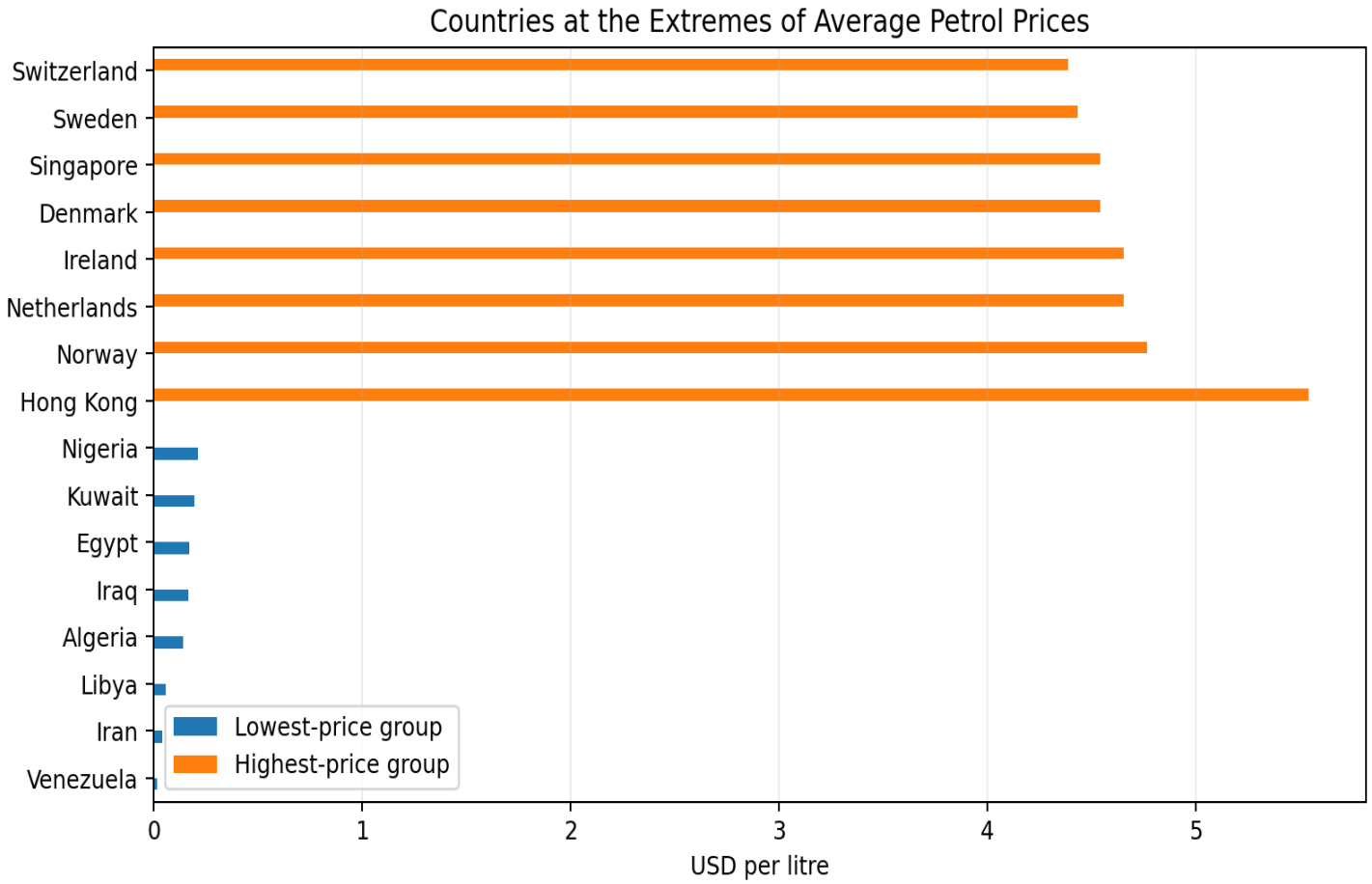
What stands out

- Europe has the highest regional average petrol price: $3.70/L.
- Middle East has the lowest regional average: $1.23/L.
- Europe's average is about 3.0× the Middle East average.
- Differences can reflect taxes, market structure, logistics and policy—not crude prices alone.

Source: supplied global_fuel_prices_Dataset(2).csv

4. Country-level extremes

SAME PRODUCT, DIFFERENT PRICE



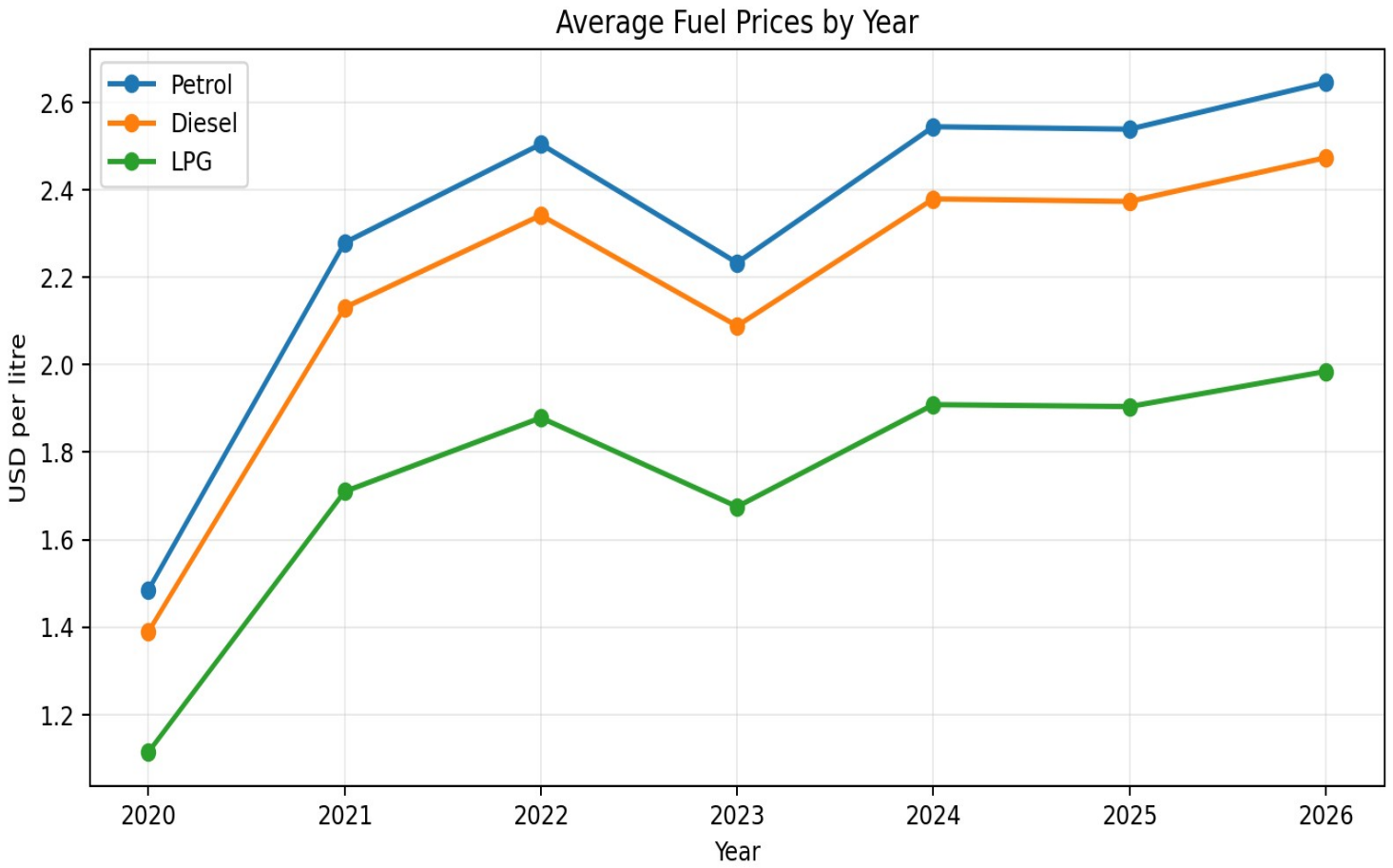
Interpretation

- Lowest average-price examples include Venezuela, Iran, Libya, Algeria.
- Highest average-price examples include Denmark, Singapore, Sweden, Switzerland.
- These are dataset averages over the available observations, not a statement about today's pump price.
- Country comparisons are more useful when paired with taxes, subsidies and income context.

Source: supplied global_fuel_prices_Dataset(2).csv

5. Prices rose, eased, then climbed again

TEMPORAL TRENDS: ANNUAL AVERAGE



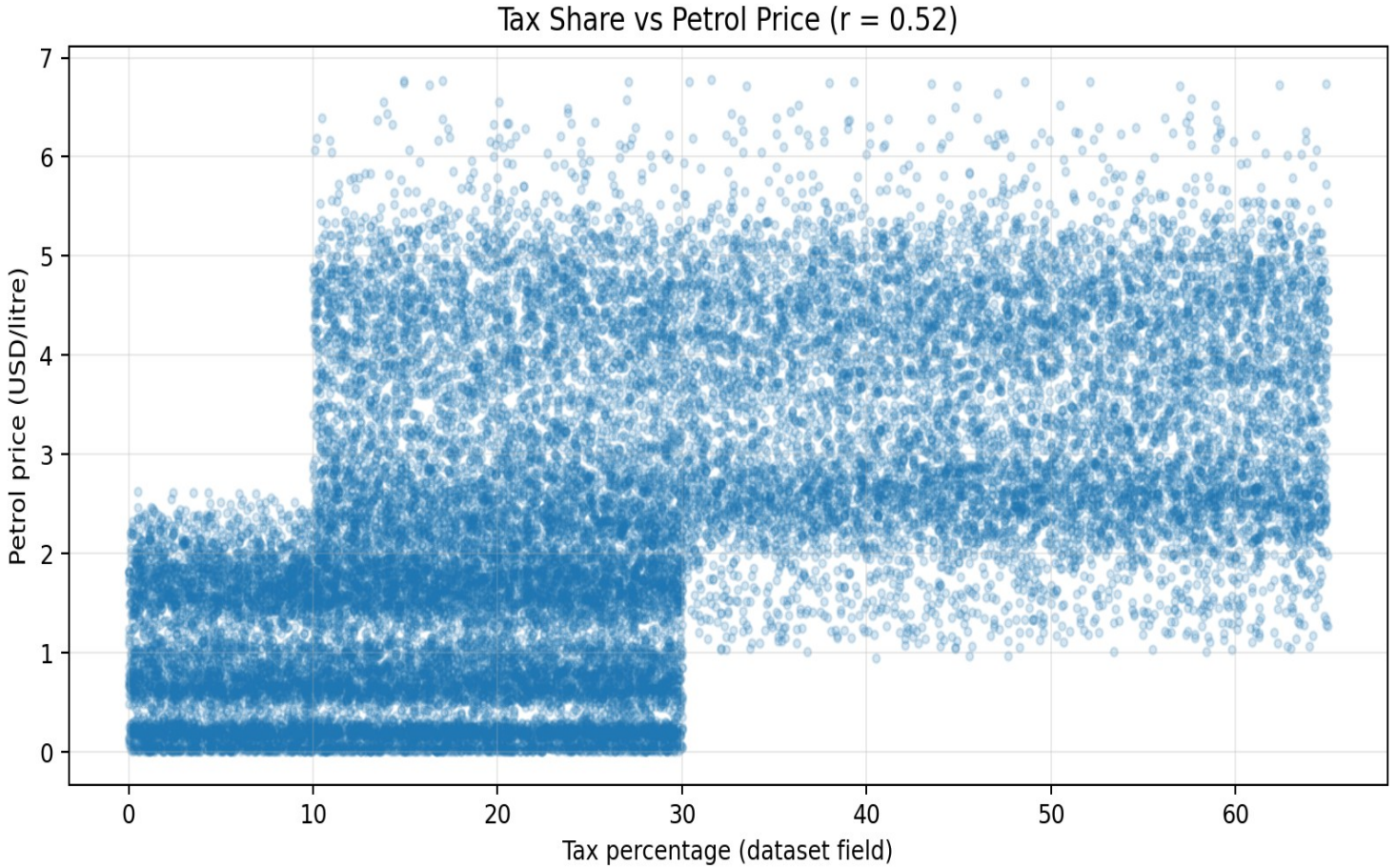
Story in the trend

- Petrol average: $1.48/L in 2020 → $2.51/L in 2022.
- It eased to $2.23/L in 2023, then rose again in later observations.
- The partial 2026 average is $2.65/L; 2026 only runs through 6 April.
- Diesel and LPG broadly follow the same direction in this dataset.

Source: supplied global_fuel_prices_Dataset(2).csv

6. Taxation is associated with higher prices

TAXATION POLICY



What the data suggests

• Petrol price and tax percentage show a positive correlation (r = 0.52).

• In this dataset, observations with higher tax percentages tend to have higher petrol prices.

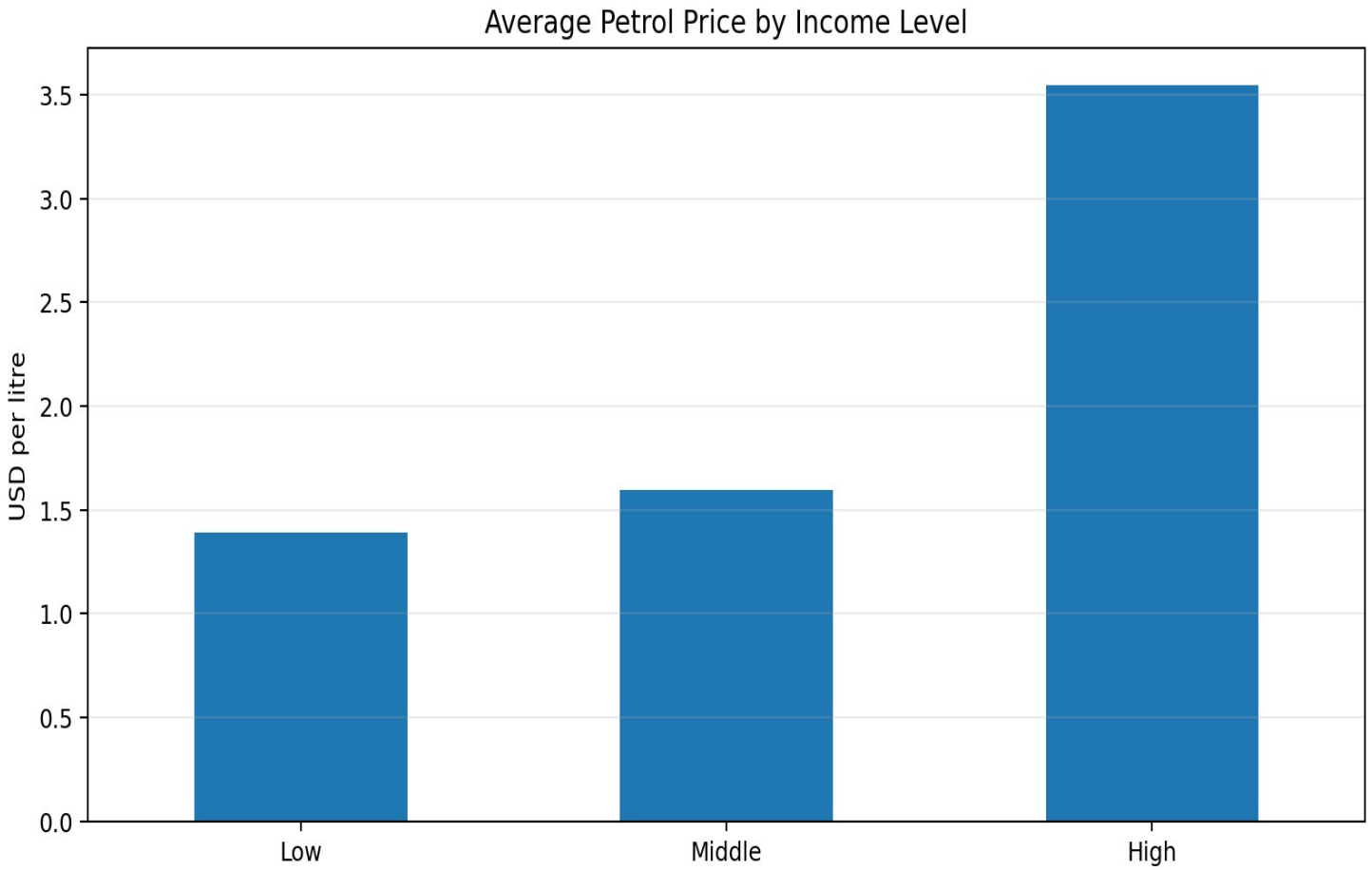
• Correlation does not establish that tax alone caused the price difference.

• A stronger policy study would compare countries over time and control for crude costs, exchange rates and subsidies.

Source: supplied global_fuel_prices_Dataset(2).csv

7. Income level and fuel price

ECONOMIC CONTEXT



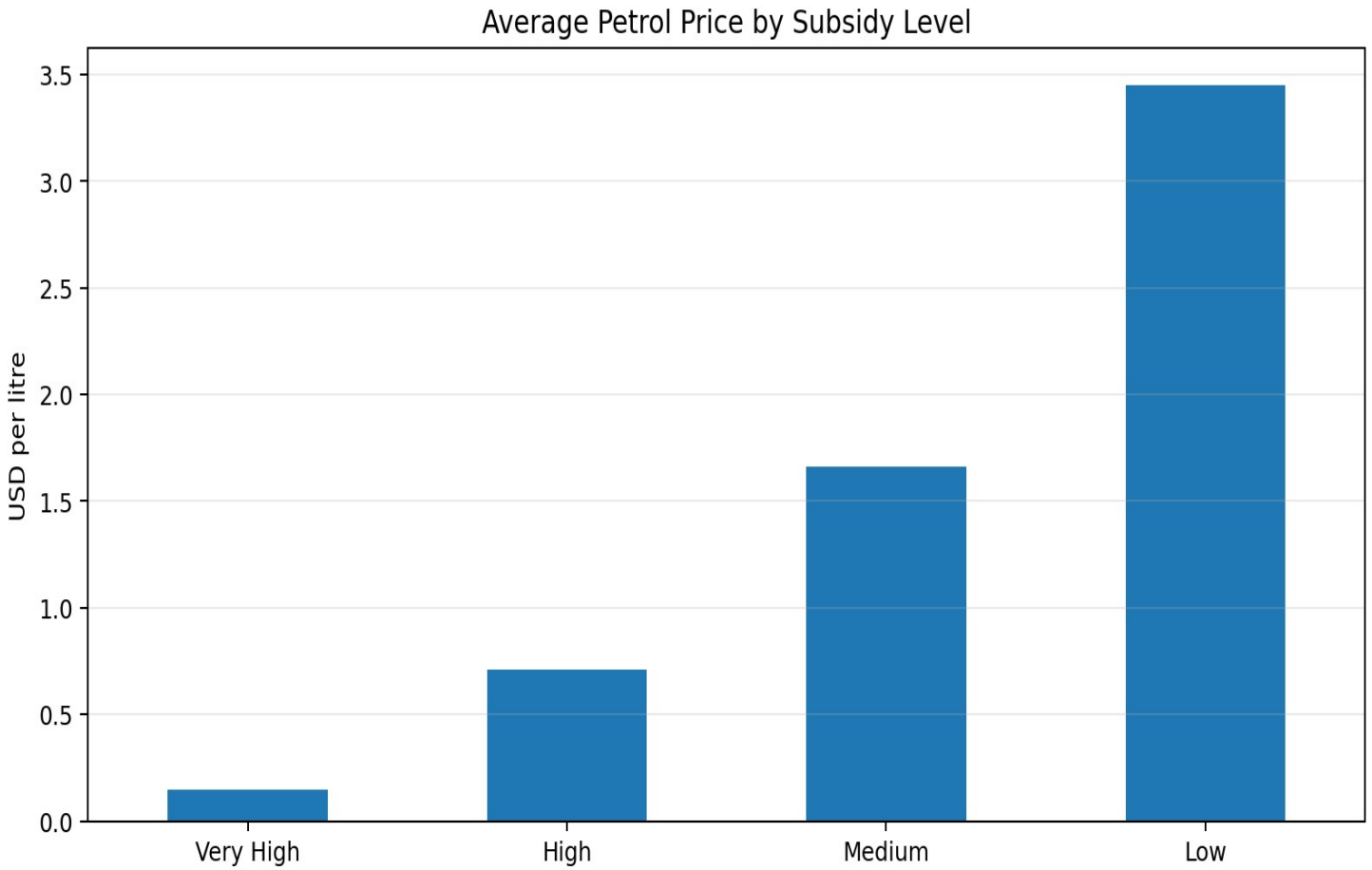
Key comparison

- High-income group average: $3.55/L.
- Middle-income group average: $1.59/L.
- Low-income group average: $1.39/L.
- This is a group-level association; it does not mean income alone determines retail prices or affordability.

Source: supplied global_fuel_prices_Dataset(2).csv

8. Subsidy categories and observed prices

GOVERNMENT SUPPORT



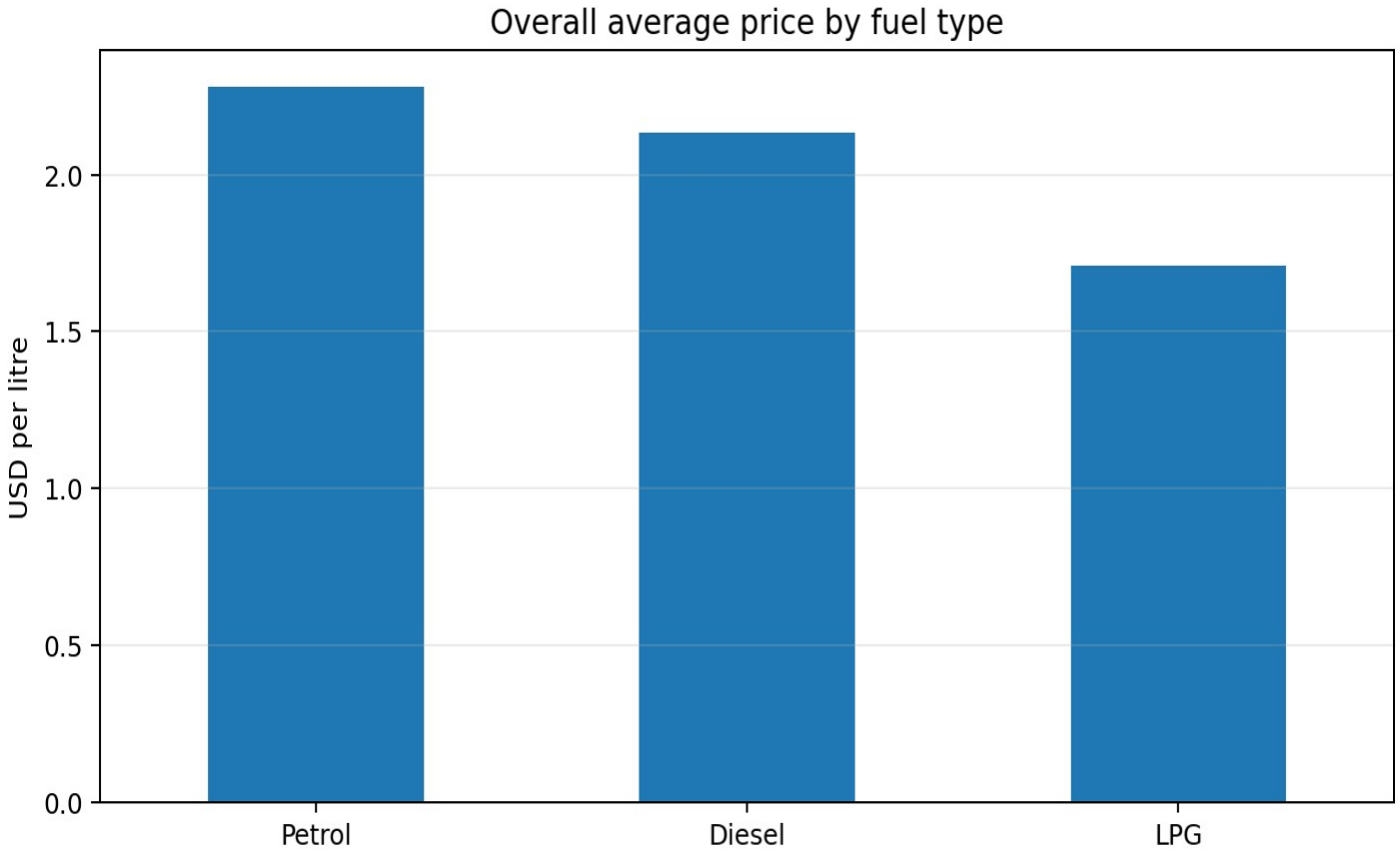
What stands out

- Very-high-subsidy group average: $0.15/L.
- Low-subsidy group average: $3.45/L.
- Lower average prices appear in the higher-subsidy categories in this dataset.
- This is not causal proof: subsidy labels may co-vary with country, tax policy and market conditions.

Source: supplied global_fuel_prices_Dataset(2).csv

9. Petrol, diesel and LPG

FUEL-TYPE COMPARISON



Reading the comparison

- Petrol overall mean: $2.28/L.
- Diesel overall mean: $2.13/L.
- LPG overall mean: $1.71/L.
- Across the dataset, LPG is the lowest-priced of these three fuels on average.

Source: supplied global_fuel_prices_Dataset(2).csv

10. Conclusions & recommendations

FROM DATA TO DECISIONS

What the story tells us

• Fuel prices differ sharply by region and country.

• Annual averages show a rise after 2020, a dip in 2023, and higher readings afterward.

• Tax percentage and subsidy category are meaningfully associated with observed prices.

• Income groups also differ, but affordability requires income-to-fuel-cost measures—not price alone.

Recommendations

• Publish transparent fuel-price breakdowns: crude, refining, distribution, tax and subsidy.

• Target support to vulnerable households and essential transport where needed.

• Assess subsidies against fiscal cost, access and environmental goals.

• Use monthly/weekly monitoring and control for exchange rates and crude benchmarks before causal claims.

Source: supplied global_fuel_prices_Dataset(2).csv

THE TAKEAWAY

Fuel prices are not just about oil.

Geography, taxation, income context and government support all appear alongside large differences in observed prices.

Limitations

This is a descriptive analysis of the supplied file. 2026 is partial; fields are not independently verified here; correlations do not prove causation. Affordability also depends on household income and fuel consumption.

Thank you | Questions?